

# Boston Sunday Globe

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## A higher cost for Boston's stadium

Similar arenas in other cities come in at lower price

By Niki Griswold  
GLOBE STAFF

As Mayor Michelle Wu frames it, Boston is getting a new White Stadium for a bargain. Thanks to a partnership with a new professional women's soccer team, the city is replacing the crumbling facility with a world-class home for Boston Public Schools student-athletes for "less than half the cost," Wu said this month.

But as the total cost balloons to \$325 million — and the city's share to \$135 million — the White Stadium rebuild now dwarfs that of similar soccer stadium projects around the country by tens of millions of dollars, if not more.

The Globe examined soccer stadium projects in Seattle, Denver, and Kansas City, Mo., all of which are being developed or were completed within the last two years. While none is an exact replica of the split-funding plan in Boston, they each are designed to be homes to women's professional soccer teams or, in Seattle's case, specifically for high school student-athletes.

STADIUM, Page A14

## Early to the fight over cost of living

Still, a tough task for Vt. governor

By Paul Heintz  
GLOBE STAFF

MONTPELIER, Vt. — As politicians from around the country gathered in Washington, D.C., over the past week for a meeting of the National Governors Association, a single term was never far from their lips: affordability.

It's become an inescapable political buzzword since last fall, when Democrats in Virginia, New Jersey, and New York City won elections promising to tackle what they called a crisis of affordability. The party has vowed to make it a centerpiece of the midterms, and governors from Massachusetts to Maine and Delaware to Indiana have rolled out so-called affordability agendas in recent weeks.

All these promises have prompted one lesser-known politician who's been campaigning on affordability for more than a dozen years to ask a simple question: Where have you been?

"Affordability has become one of the most talked-about is-

AFFORDABILITY, Page A9



ANA BRIGIDA FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

At Instituto Superior Técnico in Lisbon, Cláudio Manuel Neves Valente and Nuno Felipe Gomes Loureiro took the same foundational courses.

## The fateful divergence of two young scientists

Only one became a star. The other, his murderer.

By Marcela Rodrigues  
GLOBE STAFF

ENTRONCAMENTO, Portugal — They started out in the same place, the MIT professor and the man who killed him.

They were born the same year, 11 months and 100 miles apart in Portugal, both to middle-class Catholic families, both

growing into an insatiable love of physics.

For their first two decades, the men were on parallel tracks toward scientific greatness. The valedictorians of their high schools, both Cláudio Manuel Neves Valente and Nuno Felipe Gomes Loureiro made it to their country's most elite science uni-

versity, where they took classes and exams together for five years, part of an ambitious cohort of students who all wanted to win the Nobel Prize.

After they graduated from Instituto Superior Técnico and moved abroad, Loureiro lived up to his potential, for as long as he

PHYSICISTS, Page A12

## In the cruel, lingering grip of long COVID

As researchers try to break the code, a 28-year-old remains debilitated by the virus

By FELICE J. FREYER | GLOBE CORRESPONDENT



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Samantha Crausman spends much of her time in what she calls "aggressive rest." Her father looked in at her from outside.

For Samantha Crausman, each day begins with a tiny reservoir of energy. Every activity — eating, listening, even thinking — drains that pool, forcing her to calculate how to expend it.

*If I talk to my parents now, will I have the energy to wash my hair later?*

She follows a rigid routine and rarely leaves her bedroom. Any extra exertion can lead to the dreaded "crash," when she falls into a deep fatigue that immobilizes her for days.

Crausman's symptoms began four years ago, after she contracted COVID-19. She'd returned home from Florida to Rehoboth, Mass., to live with her parents during the pandemic. She planned to soon move to New York to launch a career in entertainment.

Now she's 28, trapped in an existence that seems to shrink with each passing year, her young life stalled.

As the world has moved on from the pandemic, some 20 mil-

lion Americans — most of them women — continue to suffer from a variety of COVID-19 symptoms, especially brain fog and fatigue. The majority of people recover from an infection within weeks, but one in 10 still have symptoms three months later, a condition that has come to be known as long COVID. More than 80 percent of those who were suffering at three months were still sick 12 months later, according to one recent study.

It's a sickness that limits a person's life to varying degrees — some can work but forgo other activities; others have to quit or work part time.

Crausman is among a small minority so severely debilitated they cannot even leave home. As part of long COVID, she has developed the symptoms of myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome or ME/CFS, a condition believed to be triggered by infections.

LONG COVID, Page A11

## The heartbreaking love story of Katherine and Bill



CAITY COLVARD CCPHOTOFACTORY

Bill Adam and Katherine McCord married on Sept. 20 in Boston. Adam died last month of sepsis.

Grief couldn't erase what the newlyweds had shared

By Meredith Goldstein  
GLOBE STAFF

On the morning of New Year's Eve, I interviewed South End newlyweds Katherine and Bill, on Zoom, gathering the details I'd need to tell the story of their courtship and marriage for our weddings column, The Big Day. They were beaming.

Their story, tragically, doesn't end like all the other blissful Big Day columns the Globe has published. But it's still a story about love, finding your people, and the importance of celebrating every good day.

Let's start with how they met. Katherine

McCord was 38 and working a great job in private equity. Her life was full; she had friends, volunteer work for the Winsor School (her alma mater), and a close bond with family and neighbors from Beacon Hill, where she grew up and lived for many years before moving to the South End.

She didn't have much time for dating; maybe that's why she set the geographic range on her Bumble profile to see men within *just 1 mile*.

On March 10, 2023, Bill Adam — 43 at the time — had taken the T to Boston. A freelance photographer, one of his favorite things to do

COUPLE, Page A14

## Blizzard warning for many

The massive nor'easter could bring up to 2 feet of snow to parts of the state. **B1.**

**A nutrition expert's tips for smarter shopping,** in the Health Issue of the **Globe Magazine.**

## Foot patrol

**Sunday:** Heavy snow later. High 34-39. Low 27-32.

**Monday:** Tapering, windy. High 31-36. Low 22-27.

Sunrise: 6:31 Sunset: 5:25

**Complete report, B10.**

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